

W05 Meeting Minutes

Action Plan

Cut together the music for Wednesday's class

- Assignee: Cody
- Schedule: Not mentioned

Flesh out a techno track

- Assignee: Cody
- Schedule: Not mentioned

Get at least an Andy in track done

- Assignee: Cody
- Schedule: Not mentioned

Export and send music options to Nick for feedback

- Assignee: Cody
- Schedule: Not mentioned

Create a mix and master template for the audiobook

- Assignee: Cody
- Schedule: Not mentioned

Ask industry people for feedback regarding audience testing

- Assignee: Cody
- Schedule: Not mentioned

Outline

Music Production Feedback

- The team discussed a suitable tempo for the music tracks, suggesting 110-120 BPM as a good range, with some tracks at 140 BPM also feeling appropriate.
 - Feedback indicated that some tracks could benefit from more modern-sounding instruments to capture the desired vibe.
 - There was a mention of a reference track that conveyed an eerie fantasy vibe, which the team aims to balance with sci-fi elements.
 - Cody expressed the need to gather music for an upcoming class and mentioned the importance of supporting others' work.
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Audiobook Production

- Cody discussed the challenges of mixing an audiobook that was originally sent in RMS format, which was confusing.
 - The team agreed on a target loudness level for the audiobook between 16 and 18 LUFS, which simplified the mixing process.
 - There was a plan to export the audiobook chapter by chapter to meet Audible's requirements, ensuring consistency across chapters.
 - Cody suggested creating a mix and master template to maintain a cohesive sound throughout the chapters.
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Project Management Concerns

- Cody expressed stress about the barrels game project, fearing a last-minute rush to complete tasks.
 - The team discussed the importance of timely communication and collaboration to avoid overwhelming workloads as deadlines approach.
 - Cody highlighted the creative challenges of music production, noting it would take the longest due to the need for back-and-forth feedback.
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Personal Updates and Health

- Cody mentioned a change in diet affecting sensitivity to sweet foods, indicating a focus on health.
 - There was a brief discussion about energy drinks and personal health choices.
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Project Updates and Communication

- Cody explains how to provide project updates and notes using the platform, emphasizing the use of hashtags for titles.

- Updates are automatically generated based on completed tasks in the project.
 - Cody mentions the importance of checking the inbox for tagged updates and comments.
 - The discussion includes the need for everyone to share their progress and updates as audience testing is due in week eight.
 - Cody suggests that sharing feedback and updates is crucial for the project's success.
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Personal Challenges and Time Management

- Cody discusses his struggles with sleep patterns and how it affects his productivity.
 - He mentions watching TV late at night, which contributes to his restlessness and poor sleep quality.
 - Cody reflects on how he used to rely on smoking to help him sleep, indicating a change in his routine.
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Project Collaboration and Roles

- Cody talks about the structure of the project teams, mentioning that the project title team consists of only two members, Nick and James.
 - He notes that Nick is handling programming while James is focused on concept and design.
 - There is a discussion about the ambitious scope of the project and the need for additional developers.
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Presentation Preparation

- Cody suggests creating a quick PowerPoint presentation to summarize their project updates and methodologies for audience testing.
 - The group discusses the need to condense their information into a five-minute presentation per group.
 - They plan to include details about their audio work and project titles in the presentation.
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Accessing Resources

- Cody inquires about accessing the GitHub repository and asks for the link.
- Discussion about cloning the repository to access integrated features.
- Cody expresses interest in finding a specific version of data, possibly through torrents.
- Cody mentions wanting to install a version of software side by side with the normal version.

Audience Testing and Feedback

- Cody discusses the need for audience testing and mentions a due date in week eight.
- There is uncertainty about who to approach for feedback, with suggestions to reach out to industry professionals.
- Cody considers asking game audio professionals for feedback rather than film audio experts.
- Discussion about the relevance of feedback from different industry professionals, including Steven and Tim.

Networking and Industry Contacts

- Cody mentions meeting with Jeff to discuss potential work opportunities in sound design.
- There is a suggestion to reach out to Claire, a composer, for insights related to music in games.
- Cody expresses interest in contacting a well-known game composer for advice, despite concerns about their availability.

Questions for Industry Professionals

- Discussion about formulating questions for game audio professionals, focusing on sound design techniques.
- Cody reflects on the challenges of mixing audio in dynamic environments compared to linear ones.
- There is a mention of the importance of ensuring all audio elements are balanced in a mix.

Sound Design Techniques

- Discussion on how to create realistic gun sounds by varying parameters such as pitch and mechanical sounds.
- Suggestions for using slight pitch offsets and random LFOs to create variations in sound, making it more dynamic.
- Ideas for varying the loudness and sharpness of sounds to simulate different bullet impacts.

Showcase Planning

- The need to collectively brainstorm questions and ideas for the upcoming showcase.
 - Discussion on how to engage the audience and differentiate between casual attendees and industry guests.
 - Consideration of using brochures for important guests and how to present information effectively.
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QR Code Engagement Strategy

- Proposal to use QR codes at the showcase to direct attendees to a website featuring capstone projects.
 - Discussion on incentivizing QR code scans by offering a chance to win prizes, such as a free year of a service.
 - The idea of using playful prompts like "scan me" to encourage interaction with the QR codes.
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Presentation Content

- Concerns about the lack of material to present at the showcase and how to effectively showcase their work.
 - Suggestions for demonstrating audio work by showing before-and-after samples of dialogue.
 - Discussion on the inclusion of background sounds and their impact on the overall presentation quality.
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General Meeting Dynamics

- Acknowledgment of the need for a structured approach to the meeting and the importance of not treating it as business as usual.
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Presentation Preparation

- Cody initially thought he needed to prepare a full presentation but later realized it was not necessary.
- He suggests thinking about what to say for the presentation regarding "Saves and his audio book."
- Cody mentions the possibility of doing a quick presentation if needed.
- There is a discussion about the ease of organizing samples and assets for the presentation.

Discussion on Chinese Special Cigarettes

- Cody talks about bringing "Chinese special cigarettes" known as "Double Happiness" for his girlfriend.
- He mentions that these cigarettes are associated with weddings and are often used in celebrations.
- There is a humorous exchange about the cultural significance of these cigarettes and their use at weddings.

Audio Editing and Software Tools

- Cody discusses the organization of audio samples and the challenges of managing them.
- He mentions using RX 9 and its good algorithm for audio editing.
- There is a conversation about using Spectral tools in audio editing and how they can be integrated into projects.
- Cody explains the process of bouncing sections of audio and the importance of time codes in the editing process.

Collaboration and Project Management

- Cody reflects on past projects and the importance of collaboration in audio editing.
- He discusses reaching out to a contact named Jeff for tips on a short film project.
- There is a mention of the need for good sound quality in the project and strategies for achieving it.

Film Production Challenges

- Ben is criticized for not contributing to the film production and is described as being excommunicated from the project.
- There was a plan to film behind-the-scenes footage while the movie was being shot, but it seems that this did not go as intended.
- Mark is mentioned as someone who will take over the responsibility of setting up cameras for behind-the-scenes footage.

Audio Software Discussion

- Cody expresses interest in the Spire audio software, noting its analog qualities and good sound.
 - There is a discussion about the compatibility of VSC 3 with 32-bit and 64-bit systems.
 - Cody mentions the challenges of using pirate software and the need for serial codes for certain audio tools.
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Sound Design Techniques

- Cody discusses the importance of ambient sound in sound design, emphasizing that not everything needs to be prominent.
 - There is a reference to a Destiny sound design example that Cody finds too complex to replicate.
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